

BYLAWS OF RISING TIDE

Adopted on: _____

ARTICLE I — NAME, VISION, AND MISSION

Section 1. Name

The name of this organization shall be **Rising Tide Community Group**.

Section 2. Vision

To create a shared space where people with diverse identities and their allies work together to expand society's sense of normal, building a culture where everyone has a real place at the table and is fully seen, fully valued, and fully accepted.

Section 3. Mission

Rising Tide brings people of all identities together through community events, visibility efforts, and public awareness rallies that celebrate diversity and expand society's sense of normal, creating a culture where all people are fully seen, valued, and belong.

ARTICLE II — MEMBERSHIP

Section 1. Eligibility

Membership is open to all individuals who support the mission and values of Rising Tide.

Section 2. Rights of Members

Members may:

- A. Attend meetings
- B. Participate in events
- C. Serve on committees
- D. Vote when eligible under Section 3

Section 3. Voting Eligibility

To vote on any organizational matter, a member must have attended **two (2) of the previous three (3)** quarterly meetings. Attendance shall be recorded by the Secretary/Treasurer.

Section 4. Non-Discrimination

Rising Tide shall not discriminate on the basis of race, gender, sexual orientation, gender identity, religion, disability, national origin, or any other identity.

ARTICLE III — BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Section 1. Composition

The Board of Directors (“the Board”) shall consist of:

- A. Chair
- B. Vice Chair
- C. Secretary/Treasurer

Section 2. Terms

Officers shall serve **two-year terms** and may be re-elected without limit.

Section 3. Vacancies

Vacancies shall be filled by a majority vote of the remaining Board members.

Section 4. Combination of Offices

- A. The Secretary role may be filled by any other existing office.
- B. No other roles may be combined.

Section 5. Other Officers

- A. Other officers may be created and assigned as needed to support specific events, projects, or operational needs of Rising Tide.
- B. These officers serve only for the duration of the need and may be removed when the need no longer exists.
- C. These officers do not serve on the Board and do not hold voting authority beyond their status as general members.

ARTICLE IV — OFFICERS AND DUTIES

Section 1. Chair

- A. Presides over all meetings

- B. Oversees organizational direction
- C. Represents Rising Tide publicly
- D. Casts the deciding vote in the event of a tie

Section 2. Vice Chair

- A. Acts in the absence of the Chair
- B. Supports organizational operations
- C. Assists with event coordination and outreach
- D. Tracks attendance for voting eligibility

Section 3. Secretary/Treasurer

- A. Maintains all records, minutes, and documents
- B. Manages all funds and financial reporting
- C. Provides financial updates at each quarterly meeting
- D. Ensures compliance with any required reporting

ARTICLE V — MEETINGS

Section 1. Regular Meetings

Rising Tide shall hold **quarterly meetings**, open to all members.

Section 2. Special Meetings

Special meetings may be called by:

- A. The Chair
- B. Any two officers

Section 3. Notice

At least **seven (7) days' notice** shall be given for all meetings.

Section 4. Quorum

A quorum for conducting official business shall consist of:

- A. **A majority of officers**, and

B. At least one (1) eligible voting member, *if any general members exist*.

If no general members are enrolled or present, the **officers alone constitute a quorum**.

Section 5. Open Meetings

- A. All meetings shall be open to all members.
- B. No secret meetings shall be held by any officer or committee.
- C. All voting must occur in open session.
- D. Proxy voting is prohibited.

Section 6. Tele-Meetings and Remote Voting

- A. Meetings may be held in whole or in part by teleconference or videoconference.
- B. Participation through electronic means shall count as being “present” for purposes of quorum and voting.
- C. All votes taken during a tele-meeting are valid and carry the same authority as votes taken in person and shall be noted as such in the secretary’s notes.

ARTICLE VI — VOTING PROCEDURES

Section 1. Voting Rights

- A. Each eligible voter has **one (1) vote**.
- B. Officers have one vote each, equal to members.
- C. The Chair casts the deciding vote in the event of a tie.
- D. Proxy voting is not permitted.

Section 2. Voting Methods

Votes may be conducted by voice, show of hands, or written ballot as determined by the Chair.

Section 3. Majority Rule

Unless otherwise specified, a simple majority of those present and eligible to vote shall decide all matters.

ARTICLE VII — REMOVAL AND MISCONDUCT

Section 1. Grounds for Removal

An officer or voting member may be removed for:

- A. Dereliction of duty
- B. Misuse of authority
- C. Unprofessional conduct
- D. Criminal activity
- E. Behavior that harms the reputation or mission of Rising Tide

Section 2. Removal Process

- A. A motion for removal may be brought by any officer.
- B. The individual shall receive written notice at least **ten (10) days** before the vote.
- C. The individual may speak in their own defense.
- D. Removal requires a **majority vote** of the officers and eligible voting members present.

ARTICLE VIII — COMMITTEES

Section 1. Standing Committees

The Board may establish committees including, but not limited to:

- A. Events Committee
- B. Visibility & Outreach Committee
- C. Communications Committee
- D. Fundraising Committee

Section 2. Appointment

Committee members shall be appointed by the Board based on willingness to serve.

Section 3. Committee Authority

Committees may make recommendations but may not take binding action without Board approval.

ARTICLE IX — FINANCES

Section 1. Use of Funds

All funds shall be used solely to support the mission and activities of Rising Tide.

Section 2. Financial Records

The Treasurer shall maintain accurate financial records and make them available upon request.

Section 3. Reporting Periods

All financial reports shall run from the 1st day of the month through the last day of the month.

Section 4. Annual Report

An annual financial report shall be presented to the membership at the first quarterly meeting of each year.

Section 5. Authorization and Signing of Checks

No check, withdrawal, or financial disbursement may be both authorized and signed by the same individual. All expenditures must require at least two officers: one to authorize the payment and a different officer to sign the check or execute the transaction. This safeguard ensures transparency and prevents misuse of organizational funds.

Section 6. Prohibition on Private Inurement and Private Benefit

No part of the net earnings of Rising Tide shall inure to the benefit of, or be distributable to, any member, officer, director, or private individual, except that the organization shall be authorized and empowered to pay reasonable compensation for services rendered and to make payments and distributions in furtherance of the purposes set forth in these bylaws. No member, officer, director, or private individual shall be entitled to share in the distribution of any corporate assets upon dissolution of the organization. Rising Tide shall not carry on any activities not permitted to organizations exempt from federal income tax under Section 501(c) of the Internal Revenue Code.

ARTICLE X — AMENDMENTS

These bylaws may be amended by a **majority vote** at any regular or special meeting, provided that written notice of the proposed amendment is given at least **ten (10) days** prior to the meeting.